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世界愛犬聯盟
World Dog Alliance

March 12th, 2024.

Your ref.: COM(2023)769. Our ref.: EU(2024)2 By: Legal Director, Him Lo.

Feedback to proposal COM(2023)769 for regulation on the welfare and traceability of dogs and cats.

World Dog Alliance has reason to believe that illegal breeders originating from third countries such as Serbia, Belarus, Russia, and Turkey are involved in breeding, not only for human companionship, but also to produce products derived from cats and dogs, such as fur.

Even though China, Thailand and the Philippines are most commonly known for dog fur export, we know for a fact that the dog fur industry is not uncommon within the countries exporting dogs to the EU market, listed in the report: Illegal trade of cats & dogs EU enforcement action, by the European Commission.

Especially those countries with an active fur industry, like Russia.
https://siberiantimes.com/other/others/news/dozens-of-dogs-killed-and-skinned-to-make-fur-hats-in-krasnoyarsk/

Regulation (EC) No 1523/2007 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 11 December 2007 banned the placing on the market and the import to, or export from, the Community of cat and dog fur, and products containing such fur.

Still, breeders in third countries, where cat and dog fur are still legal, cross-subsidize pet breeding with the production of other products derived from cats and dogs.

As a consequence, competition is distorted, especially for high standards breeders and keepers, which are unable to monetise their investments into animal welfare when they trade cross border because they are confronted with operators that profit also from products derived from cats and dogs to exert competition and drive prices and standards down. The same goes for other products derived from cats and dogs, like dog meat, often ladled as “bush meat.”

To ensure a level playing field between operators keeping and placing on the market dogs and cats across the market, the WDA suggests adding to Article 21(b):

Suggested changes to the Regulation in bold below:

CHAPTER V ENTRY OF DOGS AND CATS INTO THE UNION
Article 21
Entry of dogs and cats into the Union
1. From [5 years from the date of entry into force of this Regulation], dogs and cats may only be entered into the Union for placing on the Union market if they have been kept in compliance with any of the following:

(a) Chapters II of this Regulation;

(b) conditions recognised by the Union to be equivalent to those set out by this Regulation ***and Regulation (EC) No 1523/2007 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 11 December 2007 banning the placing on the market and the import to, or export from, the Community of cat and dog fur, and products containing such fur, and other products derived from cats and dogs,***

; or

(c) where applicable, requirements contained in a specific agreement between the Union and the exporting country.

The importance of an international perspective

Since the objectives of this Regulation, namely, to establish minimum harmonised rules that ensure the proper functioning of the internal market while ensuring a high level of welfare of dogs and cats and their traceability cannot be sufficiently achieved by the Member States alone, but can rather, by reason of its effects, be better achieved by the Union. Both the effectiveness of such Union collaboration and the very essence of the principle of subsidiarity as set out in Article 5 of the Treaty on European Union, acknowledge that international collaboration is a prerequisite of achieving the objectives of this Regulation.

Even so, the regulation limits its influence on third countries and does not go far enough to ensure a high level of welfare of dogs and cats in third countries. Animal welfare is a cross boarder issue.

The World Dog Alliance therefore uses this opportunity to urge the EU to support an international agreement prohibiting human consumption of cats and dogs. The preamble must include these values and principles.

The World Dog Alliance therefore ask for a new recital clause to be added to the preamble:

(xx)

Breeders in third countries, where products derived from cats and dogs are legal, cross-subsidize pet breeding with the production of other products derived from cats and dogs distorting competition and driving prices and standards down. Therefore, and to end the low standards of animal welfare in such establishments, the Commission should ensure the development and support of an International Agreement to prohibit products derived from cats and dogs.

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The World Dog Alliance.

The World Dog Alliance (WDA) is an international animal welfare organisation, which has been registered as a charity in the United States, France, Japan and Hong Kong.

Every year, over 30 million dogs and cats are killed for their meat in Asia, particularly in China, South Korea, Indonesia, and Vietnam.

Japanese philanthropist Genlin founded the World Dog Alliance (WDA). By working with politicians around the world, Genlin has successfully made countries and regions outlaw cat and dog meat:

- Taiwan banned dog and cat meat in 2017.
- Through the collaboration between Genlin and former U.S. Representative Jeff Denham, the U.S. banned dog and cat meat in 2018.
- In the beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic, Genlin wrote letters to the Chinese government leadership calling for an end to bushmeat and dog and cat meat. The Chinese cities, Shenzhen and Zhuhai banned dog and cat meat within a month.
- Jakarta has banned dog meat in 2023.
- Vietnam has announced plans to phase out dog meat in 2023.
- South Korea has banned dog meat in 2024 thanks to the support and strong advocacy by South Korea's First Lady, Kim Keon-hee and WDA. As the second largest dog meat eating country in the world, the dog meat ban in South Korea serves as an important victory for WDA and the anti-dog meat campaign.

Still, the barbaric practice continues. To establish an international framework for all countries to sign on, Genlin propose the International Agreement to Prohibit the Eating of Dogs and Cats.

So far, over 200 Members of Congress or Parliament from the United States, Norway, Sweden, Japan, UK and France have signed on letters to their heads of state, calling for the initiation of the International Agreement.

Kind regards.

Him Lo
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World Dog Alliance